

Static Analysis and Verification

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Automata-based LTL Model Checking

Introduction

- ❖ We need to check whether $M \models \varphi$ holds for a Kripke structure M and an LTL formula φ .
- ❖ We are going to use an automata-theoretic approach to solve the above problem.
- ❖ The semantics of LTL formulae is defined over infinite paths—hence, when considering labelling of states as letters, we need to work with infinite words over the alphabet 2^{AP} .
- ❖ We need a suitable kind of automata to represent languages of infinite words: we are going to use the so-called Büchi automata (BA) and their variants.
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 - We check that $L(\mathcal{B}_M) \cap L(\mathcal{B}_{\neg\varphi}) = \emptyset$.

Büchi Automata

for use in LTL Model Checking

Büchi automata

- ❖ A (non-deterministic) Büchi automaton $\mathcal{B}$ is a tuple $\mathcal{B} = (Q, \Sigma, \delta, Q_0, F)$ where
- Q is a finite set of **states**,
 - Σ is a finite **alphabet**,
 - $\delta \subseteq Q \times \Sigma \times Q$ is the **transition relation**,
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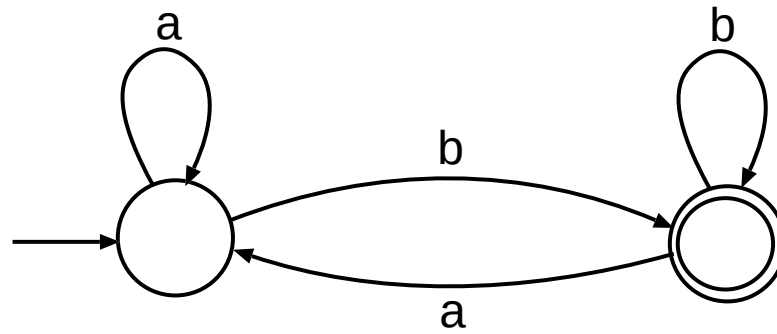
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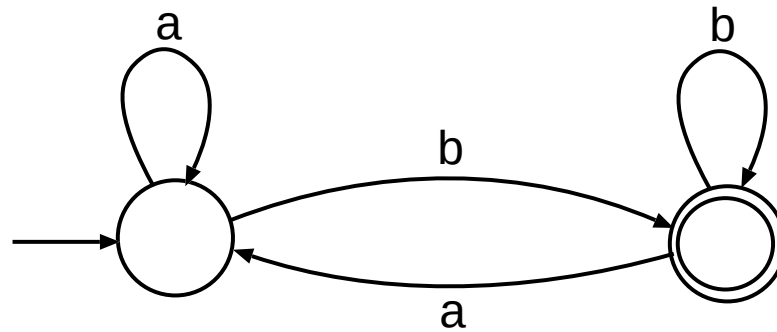
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- The **language** of $\mathcal{B}$ is defined as $L(\mathcal{B}) = \{w \in \Sigma^\omega \mid \text{there is an accepting run of } \mathcal{B} \text{ over } w\}$.

Two Examples of BA

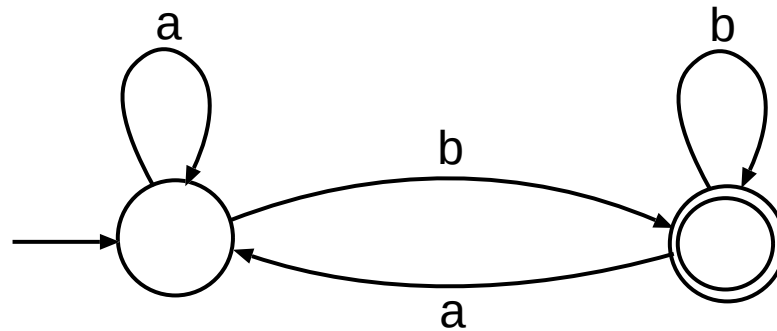


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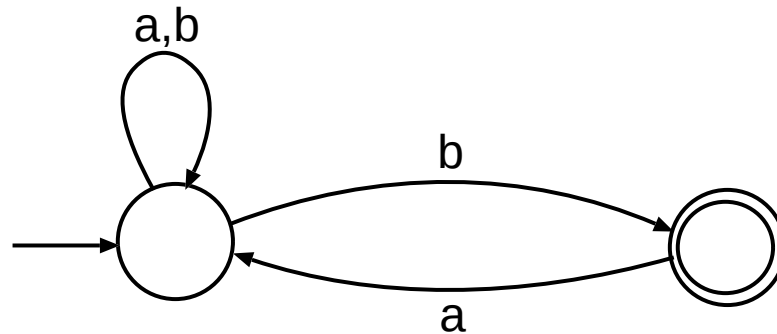


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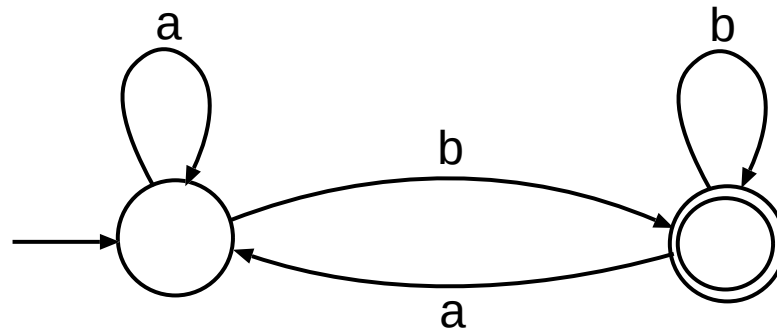
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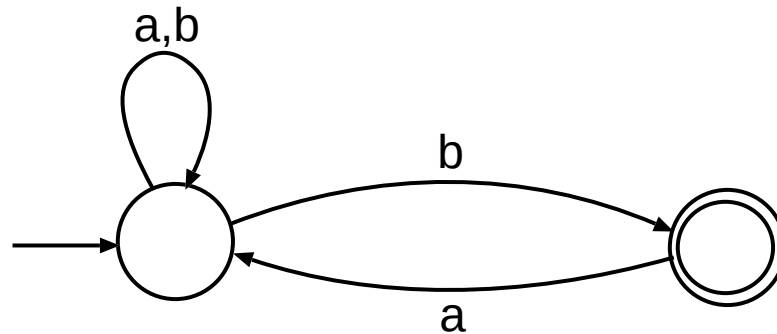
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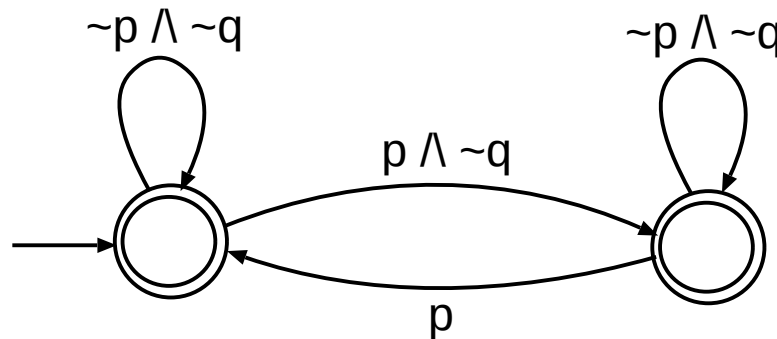
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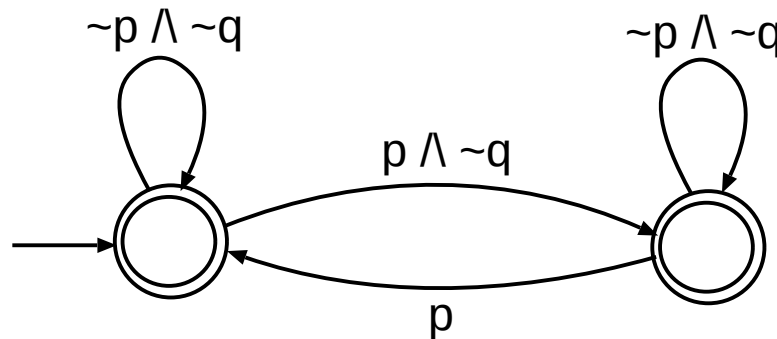


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❖ The above language is **not expressible using LTL**.

- BA have a **strictly higher expressive power** than LTL.
- The languages that are accepted by some BA are called **ω -regular**.

Alternative Accepting Conditions

❖ Several other forms of accepting conditions replacing the simple set of accepting states F are in use:

- generalised Büchi: $\mathcal{F} \subseteq 2^Q$ —a run ϱ is accepting iff $\forall F \in \mathcal{F}. \inf(\varrho) \cap F \neq \emptyset$.

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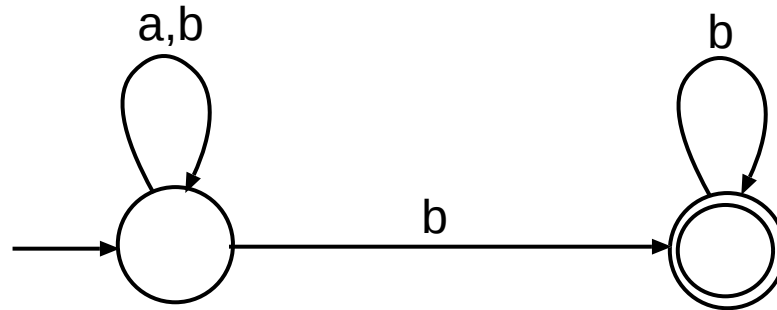
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❖ All the above conditions yield automata of equal expressive power.

Deterministic BA

❖ When considering the basic Büchi acceptance condition, **deterministic BA** are **strictly less powerful** than ordinary (non-deterministic) BA.

❖ The below BA expressing the language of words over $\Sigma = \{a, b\}$ in which **eventually only b appears** (i.e., $(a + b)^* b^\omega$) does not have a deterministic variant:



❖ Deterministic and non-deterministic **Muller, Streett, Rabin, parity, and Emerson-Lei automata** have the **same expressive power**.

Complementation of BA

❖ The automata-theoretic approach to LTL model checking could be formulated as checking whether $L(\mathcal{B}_M) \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}_\varphi)$, which would naturally reduce to using complementation to check $L(\mathcal{B}_M) \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}_\varphi)$ as $L(\mathcal{B}_M) \cap \overline{L(\mathcal{B}_\varphi)} = \emptyset$.

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- ❖ However, BA are still closed wrt complementation:
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- ❖ To avoid the complex complementation of BA, complementation is usually done on the level of formulae, and the model checking checks that $L(\mathcal{B}_M) \cap L(\mathcal{B}_{\neg\varphi}) = \emptyset$.

Emptiness of BA

- ❖ Emptiness of a given BA $\mathcal{B}$ can be checked in the following way:
 - compute the SCCs of $\mathcal{B}$, which can be done using the algorithm of Tarjan in time linear in the size of $\mathcal{B}$,
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 - Note: A naive two-phase DFS (first find accepting states, then search from each of them for a loop) gives time complexity $\mathcal{O}(|Q|. (|Q| + |\delta|))$.
- ❖ In the literature, various improved versions of both the SCC-based as well as the nested DFS have been proposed: these are beyond the scope of this lecture.

Product of BA

- ❖ Given two BA $\mathcal{B}_1, \mathcal{B}_2$, constructing a BA accepting the language $L(\mathcal{B}_1) \cap L(\mathcal{B}_2)$ is easy.
- ❖ However, one has to be careful of the fact that accepting states may be reached in $\mathcal{B}_1$ and $\mathcal{B}_2$ at **different times**.
 - Have **two copies** of the cross product of the transition graphs of $\mathcal{B}_1$ and $\mathcal{B}_2$.
 - For $q_1^1 \in F_1$, redirect each transition going from a state (q_1^1, q_1^2) to (q_2^1, q_2^2) in the first copy of the cross product to **go from (q_1^1, q_1^2) in the first copy to (q_2^1, q_2^2) in the second copy**.
 - Redirect in a similar fashion transitions from the second copy back to the first one.
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❖ In the LTL model checking procedure, the construction of the product **may be simplified** since $\mathcal{B}_M$ for a Kripke structure M will have **all states accepting**:

- Hence, no need to create two copies of the cross product.
- One can consider as accepting the states of the cross product in which the $\mathcal{B}_{\neg\varphi}$ component reaches an accepting state.

From Kripke Structures to Büchi Automata

From KS to BA

❖ We transform a given Kripke structure $M = (S, S_0, R, L)$ over atomic propositions from AP to the Büchi automaton $\mathcal{B}_M = (S \cup \{q_0\}, 2^{AP}, \delta, \{q_0\}, S \cup \{q_0\})$ where

- $q_0 \notin S$ and
- δ is the smallest relation such that
 - if $(s_1, s_2) \in R$, then $(s_1, L(s_2), s_2) \in \delta$ and
 - if $s_0 \in S_0$, then $(q_0, L(s_0), s_0) \in \delta$.

❖ We have that $L(\mathcal{B}_M) = \{L(s_0)L(s_1)L(s_2)\dots \mid s_0 \in S_0 \wedge s_0s_1s_2\dots \in \Pi(M, s_0)\}$.

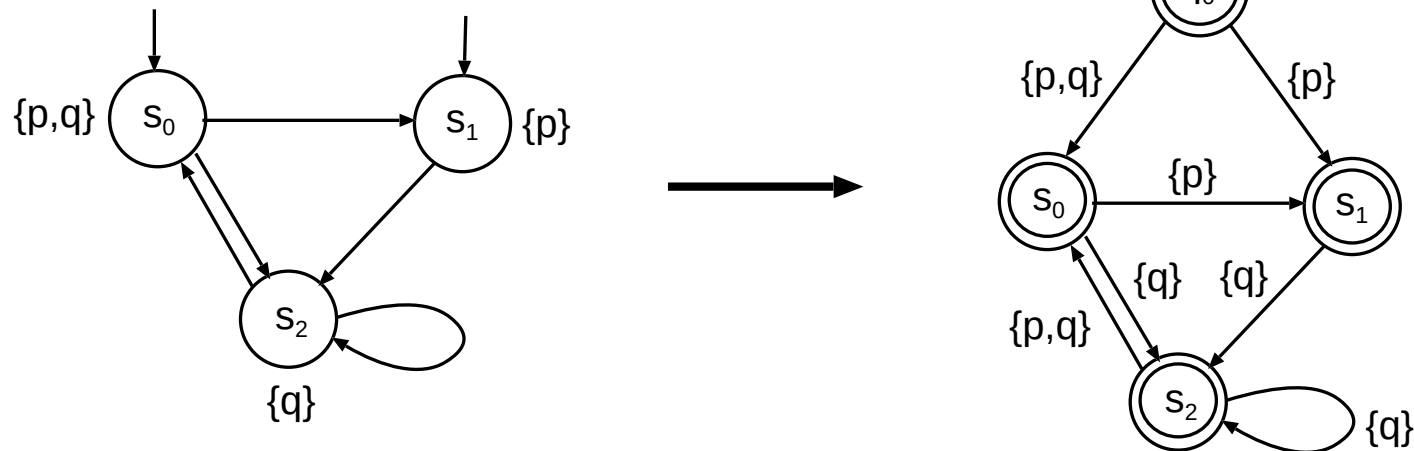
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❖ An example:



From LTL Formulae to Büchi Automata

The Idea of Going from LTL to BA

- ❖ We consider the **basic connectives** ($\neg$, $\vee$, X , U) only and we skip the use of the implicit A path quantifier at the beginning of the formulae.
- ❖ We introduce a **state** q for each **consistent subset of the set of subformulae** of the given formula and **their negations**: these are assumed to hold in q .
- ❖ We add **transitions** according to the **observed changes in the validity of atomic propositions** (the sets of the new valid atomic propositions will label the transitions) and according to the **temporal operators** that appear in the formulae present in the states.
- ❖ We use **generalised BA**: **one accepting condition for each until**.
 - The generalised BA may be **converted to plain BA** in a similar way as in the product construction (just using as many copies as the number of accepting conditions is).
- ❖ Various **alternative, more optimised constructions** have been studied (and are available in tools such as `ltl2ba`).

The FL Closure of a Formula

❖ Let φ be an LTL formula built over atomic propositions from AP using the connectives $\neg$, $\vee$, X , and U . The **Fischer-Ladner (FL) closure** $cl(\varphi)$ of φ is defined inductively on the structure of φ (assuming that $\neg\neg\varphi \equiv \varphi$):

- $cl(p) = \{p, \neg p\}$ for $p \in AP$,
- $cl(\neg\varphi) = cl(\varphi) \cup \{\neg\varphi\}$,
- $cl(\varphi_1 \vee \varphi_2) = cl(\varphi_1) \cup cl(\varphi_2) \cup \{\varphi_1 \vee \varphi_2, \neg(\varphi_1 \vee \varphi_2)\}$,
- $cl(X \varphi) = cl(\varphi) \cup \{X \varphi, \neg X \varphi\}$,
- $cl(\varphi_1 U \varphi_2) = cl(\varphi_1) \cup cl(\varphi_2) \cup \{\varphi_1 U \varphi_2, \neg(\varphi_1 U \varphi_2)\}$,

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❖ Example:

$$cl((pUq) \vee (\neg pUq)) = \left\{ \begin{array}{ll} (pUq) \vee (\neg pUq), & \neg((pUq) \vee (\neg pUq)), \\ (pUq), & \neg(pUq), \\ (\neg pUq), & \neg(\neg pUq), \\ p, \neg p, & q, \neg q \end{array} \right\}$$

Consistent Sets of Formulae

❖ We want to restrict the construction to sets of formulae that **do not contain contradictory formulae** (i.e., formulae that can never hold together).

❖ Given an LTL formula φ with the chosen basic connectives, we call a set $q \subseteq cl(\varphi)$ **consistent** iff the following conditions hold:

1. $\forall \psi \in cl(\varphi). \psi \in q \iff \neg \psi \notin q.$
2. $\forall (\psi_1 \vee \psi_2) \in cl(\varphi). (\psi_1 \vee \psi_2) \in q \iff \psi_1 \in q \vee \psi_2 \in q.$
3. $\forall (\psi_1 U \psi_2) \in cl(\varphi). \psi_2 \in q \implies (\psi_1 U \psi_2) \in q.$
4. $\forall (\psi_1 U \psi_2) \in cl(\varphi). (\psi_1 U \psi_2) \in q \wedge \psi_2 \notin q \implies \psi_1 \in q.$

Constructing $\mathcal{B}_\varphi$

❖ Given an LTL formula φ built over atomic propositions from AP using the basic connectives $\neg, \vee, X, U$, the **generalised BA** $\mathcal{B}_\varphi = (Q, 2^{AP}, \delta, Q_0, \mathcal{F})$ is defined as follows:

- $Q = \{q_0\} \cup \{q \subseteq cl(\varphi) \mid q \text{ is consistent}\}$, $q_0 \notin 2^{cl(\varphi)}$, and $Q_0 = \{q_0\}$.

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 - $(q_1, a, q_2) \in \delta$ for $q_1 \neq q_0$ iff
 1. $q_2 \neq q_0$,
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- $\mathcal{F} = \{\{q \in Q \setminus \{q_0\} \mid \psi_2 \in q \vee (\psi_1 U \psi_2) \notin q\} \mid (\psi_1 U \psi_2) \in cl(\varphi)\}$.
 - Guarantees that each until (once encountered) will reach its end (i.e., a state where its right operand holds).

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❖ We have that $L(\mathcal{B}_\varphi) = \{L(s_0)L(s_1)L(s_2)\dots \mid \text{there is a KS } M = (S, S_0, R, L) \text{ over } AP \text{ such that } s_0 \in S_0, s_0s_1s_2\dots \in \Pi(M, s_0), \text{ and } M, s_0s_1s_2\dots \models \varphi\}$.

An Example of Translating from LTL to BA

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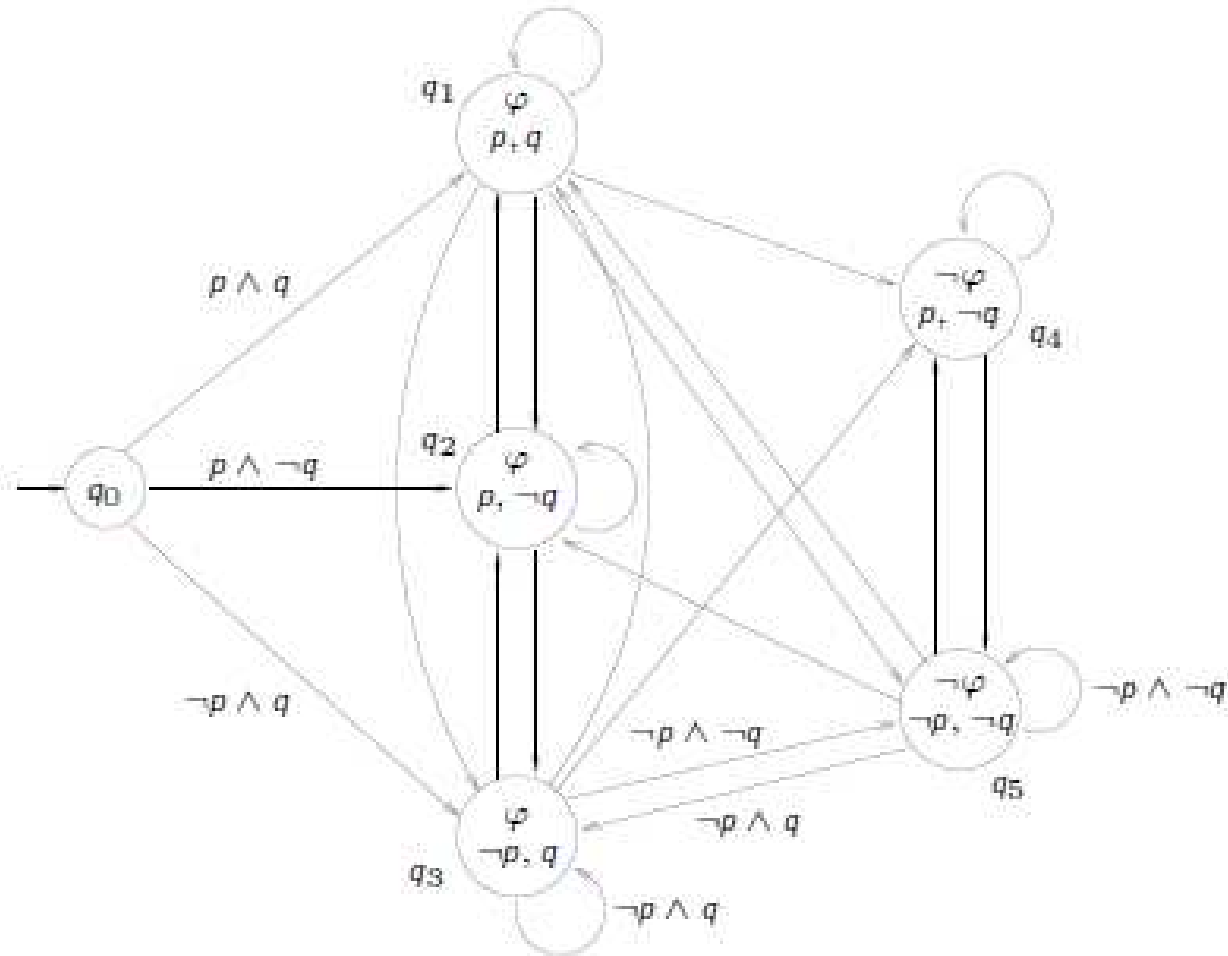
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 - $q_1 = \{\varphi, p, q\}$,
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 - $q_3 = \{\varphi, \neg p, q\}$,
 - $q_4 = \{\neg\varphi, p, \neg q\}$,
 - $q_5 = \{\neg\varphi, \neg p, \neg q\}$,

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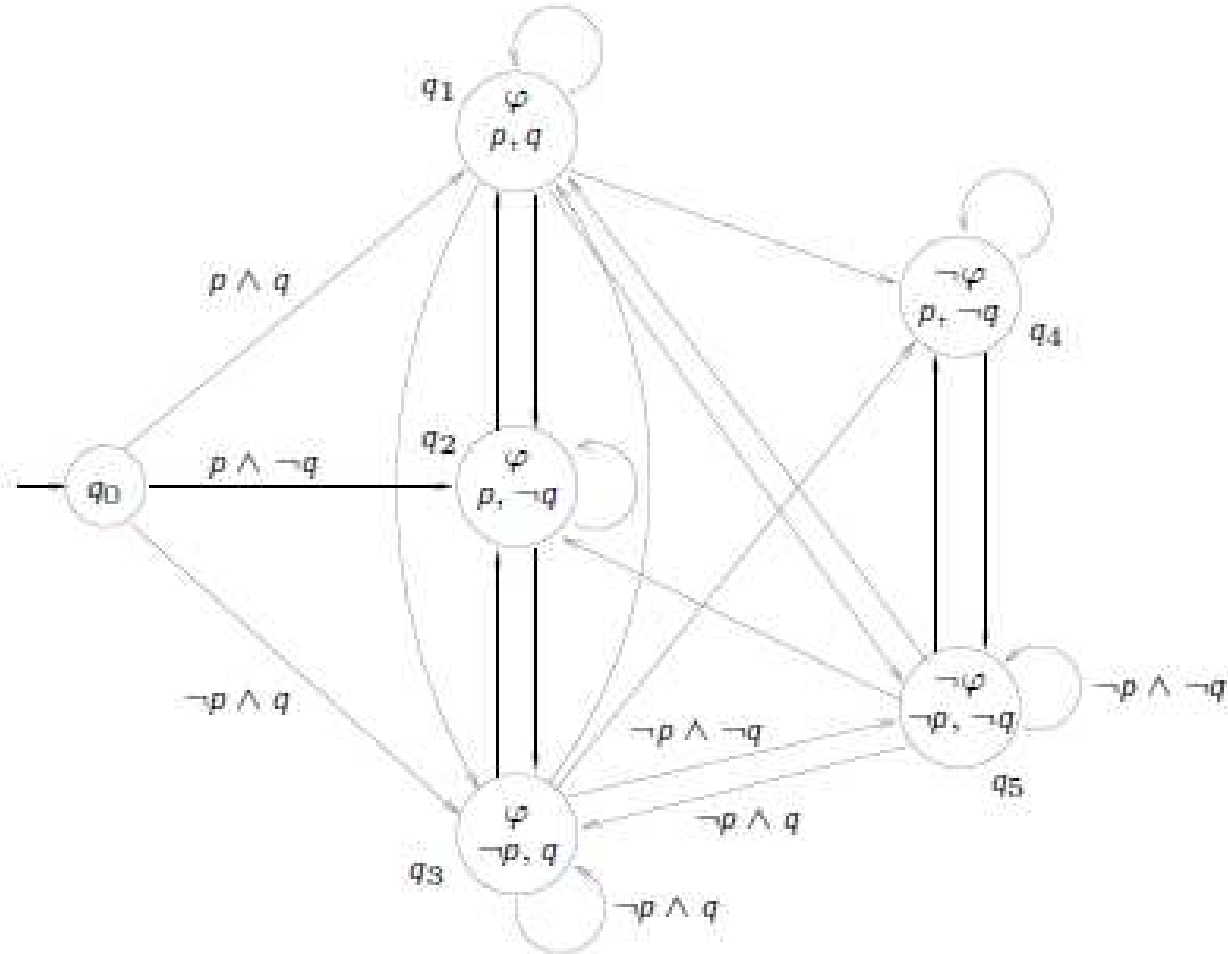
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- $\mathcal{F} = \{\{q_1, q_3, q_4, q_5\}\}$.



The Top Level of the LTL MC Algorithm

A Naive LTL MC Algorithm

❖ A naïve procedure:

1. generate the **KS** M for the given system to be verified and the atomic observations AP of interest,
2. translate M to the **BA** $\mathcal{B}_M$,
3. **negate** the given LTL formula φ to be checked and translate the negation into the **BA** $\mathcal{B}_{\neg\varphi}$,
4. construct the product **BA** $\mathcal{B}_M \times \mathcal{B}_{\neg\varphi}$ representing the language $L(\mathcal{B}_M) \cap L(\mathcal{B}_{\neg\varphi})$,
5. check **language emptiness** of $\mathcal{B}_M \times \mathcal{B}_{\neg\varphi}$:
 - if $L(\mathcal{B}_M \times \mathcal{B}_{\neg\varphi})$ is **empty**, φ **holds** for the given system,
 - otherwise return a path corresponding to some element from the intersection as a **counterexample** to the property being checked.

On-the-Fly LTL MC Algorithm

- ❖ Differences of on-the-fly model checking from the naïve procedure:
 - Do not generate the KS M and the BA $\mathcal{B}_M$ first, only then constructing the product with the negated property BA, followed by checking its emptiness.

On-the-Fly LTL MC Algorithm

❖ Differences of **on-the-fly model checking** from the **naïve procedure**:

- Do not generate the KS M and the BA $\mathcal{B}_M$ first, only then constructing the product with the negated property BA, followed by checking its emptiness.
- Instead, construct $\mathcal{B}_{\neg\varphi}$ and use it to **control the construction** of $\mathcal{B}_M$ and the product $\mathcal{B}_M \times \mathcal{B}_{\neg\varphi}$ while **continuously checking for accepting loops**:

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 - when some transition from the state of $\mathcal{B}_M$ that is currently being explored cannot be composed with the currently executable transitions of $\mathcal{B}_{\neg\varphi}$, do not follow it (no counterexample can be reached via the transition—hence, the sub-state space reachable (exclusively) via it needs not be explored).

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- Combine the on-the-fly generation of states of M with suitable **state space reduction techniques**, e.g.,
 - **partial order reduction** (exploring only some interleavings of the concurrent processes running in the verified system) or
 - **symmetry reduction** (do not explore states that are indistinguishable from some already generated states wrt the property being checked),
 - **bit-state hashing** (do not distinguish states with the same hash), ...